Victor Funes-Leal

Updated: November 11, 2026

Contact Information

Department of Agricultural Economics and Agribusiness
University of Arkansas
217 Agriculture Building
Fayetteville, AR 72701

+1 217-721-4202
vf006@uark.edu
https://victorefunes.github.io/

Education

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, Urbana, IL

Ph.D., Agricultural and Consumer Economics, 2024

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, Urbana, IL

M.Sc., Applied Statistics, 2023

National University of La Plata, La Plata, Argentina

M.A., Economics, 2015

Economics, National University of Tucumán, Tucumán, Argentina

B.A. (Licenciado), Economics, 2006

Professional Experience

Postdoctoral Fellow — Nov. 2024 - Present
Department of Agricultural Economics and Agribusiness
University of Arkansas
Supervisor: Lawson Connor

Research Assistant — May 2021 - May 2024
Department of Agricultural and Consumer Economics
University of Illinois at Urbana - Champaign
Supervisor: Jared Hutchins

Consultant — Jan. 2015 to Dec.r 2015
The World Bank
Remote Supervisors: Ezequiel Molina and Christophe Rockmore

Research Assistant — Dec. 2013 to Jan. 2015
Center for Distributive, Labor and Social Studies (CEDLAS)
La Plata, Argentina
Supervisor: Leonardo Gasparini and María Laura Alzúa

Economic Analyst — Apr. 2008 to Dec. 2012
Fundación del Tucuman
Tucumán, Argentina

Research Assistant — Mar. 2005 to Dec. 2006
Universidad Nacional de Tucumán
Tucumán, Argentina

Fields of Research Interest

Primary: Production Economics, Applied Econometrics
Secondary: Agricultural Economics, Development Economics

Working Papers

Park, Eunchun; Connor, Lawson; Viens, Frederi; **Funes-Leal, Victor**; Pizzo, Gina; Bagwell, Tyler; McLauchlan, Aria; and Cross, Harley **"Crop Insurance and the Pricing of Risk-Reducing Practices: Evidence from Rotational Complexity"**

Connor, Lawson; **Funes-Leal, Victor** and Park, Eunchun **"Crop Rotations, Transition Costs, and the Path Dependence of Farm Delinquency"**

Funes-Leal, Victor and Jared Hutchins. **"The Price of Fame: The Effect of Award-Winning Pedigrees on the Price of Livestock Genetics"**

Publications

Funes-Leal, Victor and Hutchins, Jared. 2026. **"Competing for Quality: Coordination Failure in Dairy Genetics Markets"**, Under review.
Hutchins, Jared and **Funes-Leal, Victor**. 2025. **"After One Decade of Genomic Testing, Are Milk Yields Being Impacted?"**, *Choices Magazine*

Gatti, Nicolás, **Funes-Leal, Victor**, and Amaro, Ignacio. 2024. **"Economic Value of Brangus Cattle Traits in Argentina"**, *Agribusiness: an International Journal*, 1-14

Alejo, Javier, and **Funes-Leal, Víctor**. 2021. **"Ecuaciones de Mincer de parejas bajo un esquema de selección bivariado" (Mincer Equations for Couples under a Bivariate Selection Model)**, *Revista de Análisis Económico* 36(1): 3-23

Grants and Fellowships

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

ACE Department Travel Grant	2022 and 2023
Global Food Security Graduate Fellowship	2022
Marilyn Downsing Fellowship	2019
Henry Fellowship	2018

Universidad Nacional de La Plata

MA in Economics Fellowship	2014

Conference Presentations

"Crop Rotations, Transition Costs, and Farm Delinquencies" AAEA Annual meeting	July 2026 Kansas City, MO
"Crop Rotations, Transition Costs, and Farm Delinquencies" WAEA Annual meeting	June 2026 Flagstaff, AZ
"Challenges of Incorporating Rotation Information into Crop Insurance Rates " AAEA Annual meeting	July 2025 Denver, CO
"Rainfall, climate Shifts, and Impacts on Forage production Risks: Implications for Index-based Insurance Rating" SCC76 Annual Meeting	April 2025 Kansas City, MO
"Information Provision and Network Externalities: The Impact of Genomic Testing on the Dairy Industry" NC1034 Annual Meeting	March 2024 Fort Collins, CO
"Economic Value of Expected Progeny Differences (EPDs) : of Angus and Brangus cattle breeds in Argentina" Poster presented at the AAEA Annual Meeting	July 2023 Washington, DC
"Economic Value of Expected Progeny Differences (EPDs) : of Angus and Brangus cattle breeds in Argentina"	July 2023 Buenos Aires, Argentina

Poster presented at the 27^{th} Annual Meeting of the
International Consortium for Applied Bioeconomic Research

"The Price of Fame: The Effect of Award-Winning Pedigrees on the Price of Livestock Genetics" — August 2022, Anaheim, CA
Poster presented at the AAEA Annual Meeting

Teaching Experience

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

Applied Econometrics — Fall 2023
Teaching Assistant

Spreadsheet Models and Applications
Teaching Assistant — Spring 2020

Environmental and Development Economics
Teaching Assistant — Fall 2019-Fall 2020

National University of the Northeast — 2017-2026

Applied Econometrics (online course)
Lecturer — Fall 2024, Spring 2025, and Spring 2026

Mathematics for Economists
Lecturer — Spring 2017 - Spring 2018

Introductory Statistics
Lecturer — Fall 2017

National University of the La Plata — 2015

Impact evaluation of Public Policies
Teaching Assistant — Spring 2015

Departmental and Professional Services

Referee services: American Association for Agricultural Economics (2022, 2023, and 2024), Argentinean Agricultural Economics Review (2023)
Member of the Graduate Students Organization from the Agricultural and Consumer Economics Department (2021)

Computer Programs

Python, Stata, R, LaTeX, Git (Advanced)
Matlab, ArcGIS, SQL, Unix Shell (Intermediate)
Citizenship: Argentina
Languages: Spanish (Native), English (Advanced)

References

Lawson Connor
Assistant Professor — 479-575-2256
Agricultural Economics and Agribusiness — lconnor@uark.edu
University of Arkansas

Eunchun Park
Assistant Professor — 479-575-2256
Agricultural Economics and Agribusiness — park@uark.edu
University of Arkansas

Jared Hutchins
Assistant Professor — 217-300-6781
Agricultural and Consumer Economics — jhtchns2@illinois.edu
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign